

Power of Interest
Social Media Policy

Version: V.1

Approved by: Maria Fargher

Approval date:

Review date:

Introduction

What is social media?

Social media is the term given to web-based tools and applications which enable users to create and share content (words, images and video content), and network with each other through the sharing of information, opinions, knowledge and common interests. Examples of social media include Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn and Instagram.

Why do we use social media?

Social media is essential to the success of communicating Power of Interest's (POI's) work. It is important for some staff to participate in social media to engage with our audience, participate in relevant conversations and raise the profile of POI's work.

Why do we need a social media policy?

The difference between a personal and professional opinion can be blurred on social media, particularly if you're discussing issues relating to POI's work. While we encourage the use of social media, we have certain standards, outlined in this policy, which we require everyone to observe. Publication and commentary on social media carries similar obligations to any other kind of publication or commentary in the public domain.

This policy is intended for all staff members of all levels, volunteers and directors, and applies to content posted on both a POI device and a personal device. Before engaging in work-related social media activity, staff must read this policy.

Setting out the social media policy

This policy sets out guidelines on how social media should be used to support the delivery and promotion of POI, and the use of social media by staff in both a professional and personal capacity. It sets out what you need to be aware of when interacting in these spaces and is designed to help staff support and expand our official social media channels, while protecting the charity and its reputation and preventing any legal issues.

Point of contact for social media

Our Social Media Team is responsible for the day-to-day publishing, monitoring and management of our social media channels. If you have specific questions about any aspect of these channels, speak to the Social Media Manager. No other staff member can post content on POI's official channels without the written permission of a director or member.

Which social media channels do we use?

POI uses the following social media channels:

Instagram https://www.instagram.com/power_of_interest/

LinkedIn <https://www.linkedin.com/company/poi-power-of-interest/>

Guidelines

Using POI's social media channels — appropriate conduct

1. The Social Media Team is responsible for setting up and managing POI's social media channels. Only those authorised to do so by the Social Media Manager will have access to these accounts.
2. Be an ambassador for our brand. Staff should ensure they reflect POI's values in what they post and use our tone of voice. Our brand guidelines set out our tone of voice that all staff should refer to when posting content on POI's social media channels.
3. Make sure that all social media content has a purpose and a benefit for POI, and accurately reflects POI's agreed position.
4. Bring value to our audience(s). Answer their questions, help and engage with them
5. Take care with the presentation of content. Make sure that there are no typos, misspellings or grammatical errors. Also check the quality of images.
6. Always pause and think before posting. That said, reply to comments in a timely manner, when a response is appropriate.
7. If staff outside of the Social Media Team wish to contribute content for social media, whether non-paid for or paid for advertising, they should speak to the Social Media Team about this.
8. Staff shouldn't post content about supporters or service users without their express permission. If staff are sharing information about supporters, service users or third party organisations, this content should be clearly labelled so our audiences know it has not come directly from POI. If using interviews, videos or photos that clearly identify a child

or young person, staff must ensure they have the consent of a parent or guardian before using them on social media.

9. Always check facts. Staff should not automatically assume that material is accurate and should take reasonable steps where necessary to seek verification, for example, by checking data/statistics and being wary of photo manipulation.
10. Be honest. Say what you know to be true or have a good source for. If you've made a mistake, don't be afraid to admit it.
11. Staff should refrain from offering personal opinions via POI's social media accounts, either directly by commenting or indirectly by 'liking', 'sharing', 'retweeting' or 'reposting'. If you are in doubt about POI's position on a particular issue, please speak to the Social Media Team.
12. It is vital that POI does not encourage others to risk their personal safety or that of others, to gather materials. For example, a video of a stunt.
13. Staff should not encourage people to break the law to supply material for social media, such as using unauthorised video footage. All relevant rights for usage must be obtained before publishing material.
14. Staff should not set up other Facebook groups or pages, Twitter accounts or any other social media channels on behalf of POI. This could confuse messaging and brand awareness. By having official social media accounts in place, the Social Media Team can ensure consistency of the brand and focus on building a strong following.
15. POI is not a political organisation and does not hold a view on party politics or have any affiliation with or links to political parties.

16. If a complaint is made on POI's social media channels, staff should seek advice from the Social Media Manager before responding. If they are not available, then staff should speak to a member.

17. Sometimes issues can arise on social media which can escalate into a crisis situation because they are sensitive or risk serious damage to the charity's reputation. Examples of this include serious complaints about POI online, safeguarding allegations, a data breach or accidental sharing of personal information, offensive or inappropriate posts by volunteers, fake accounts impersonating POI, viral misinformation about the organisation, threats, harassment, or abusive behaviour directed at participants or staff. The nature of social media means that complaints are visible and can escalate quickly. Not acting can be detrimental to the charity.

The Social Media Team regularly monitors our social media spaces for mentions of POI so we can catch any issues or problems early. If there is an issue that could develop or has already developed into a crisis situation, the Social Media Team will do the following:

1. Identify and Assess the Situation

The Social Media Team will immediately assess:

- What has happened.
- Who is affected.
- Whether there is any safeguarding risk.
- Whether the issue is likely to escalate.
- Whether legal, regulatory, or reputational concerns exist.

2. Escalate Internally

The issue will be reported immediately to:

- The Social Media Manager;
- The designated Director;
- The Safeguarding Lead (if children or vulnerable individuals are involved);

No individual volunteer should respond independently to a major incident without authorisation.

3. Preserve Evidence

The team will:

- Take screenshots of relevant posts, comments, messages, and accounts.
- Record dates, times, and URLs.
- Keep a written log of actions taken.

Content should not be deleted unless necessary for safeguarding, legal, or platform reporting reasons.

4. Agree a Response

The leadership team will decide whether to:

- Monitor the situation;
- Issue a public statement;
- Correct misinformation;
- Respond privately;
- Hide or remove comments;
- Report content to the platform;
- Contact the police or relevant authorities.

All public statements must be approved by a Director before publication.

5. Safeguarding Concerns

Where the incident involves:

- A child or young person;
- Bullying or harassment;
- Threats of harm;
- Inappropriate contact;
- Disclosure of abuse;

The Safeguarding Policy and Incident Reporting Procedure will be followed immediately.

6. Media Enquiries

Only authorised spokespeople (normally a Director) may speak to journalists or issue official statements on behalf of POI.

Volunteers and staff must not provide personal opinions or comments to the media.

7. Post-Incident Review

Following the incident, POI will:

- Review how the situation was handled;
- Identify lessons learned;
- Update policies and procedures if necessary;
- Provide support to anyone affected;
- Record the incident in the organisation's risk register.

If any staff outside of the Social Media Team become aware of any comments online that they think have the potential to escalate into a crisis, whether on POI's social media channels or elsewhere, they should speak to the Social Media Manager immediately.

Use of personal social media accounts — appropriate conduct

This policy does not intend to inhibit personal use of social media but instead flags up those areas in which conflicts might arise. POI staff are expected to behave appropriately, and in ways that are consistent with POI's values and policies, both online and in real life.

1. Be aware that any information you make public could affect how people perceive POI.
You must make it clear when you are speaking for yourself and not on behalf of POI. If you are using your personal social media accounts to promote and talk about POI's work, you must use a disclaimer such as: "The views expressed on this site are my own and don't necessarily represent POI's positions, policies or opinions."
2. Staff who have a personal blog or website which indicates in any way that they work at POI should discuss any potential conflicts of interest with their line manager and the Social Media Team. Similarly, staff who want to start blogging and wish to say that they work for POI should discuss any potential conflicts of interest with the Social Media Team.
3. Those in senior management, and specialist roles where they are well known in their field of expertise, must take particular care as personal views published may be misunderstood as expressing POI's view.

4. Use common sense and good judgement. Be aware of your association with POI and ensure your profile and related content is consistent with how you wish to present yourself to the general public, colleagues, partners and funders.
5. POI works with several high profile organisations, including. Please don't approach high profile people from your personal social media accounts to ask them to support the charity, as this could hinder any potential relationships that are being managed by the Social Media Team. This includes asking for retweets about the charity. If you have any information about high profile people that have a connection to our cause, or if there is someone who you would like to support the charity, please speak to the Social Media Team to share the details.
6. If a staff member is contacted by the press about their social media posts that relate to POI, they should talk to the Social Media Team immediately and under no circumstances respond directly.
7. POI is not a political organisation and does not hold a view on party politics. When representing POI, staff are expected to hold POI's position of neutrality. Staff who are politically active in their spare time need to be clear in separating their personal political identity from POI, and understand and avoid potential conflicts of interest.
8. Never use POI's logos or trademarks unless approved to do so. Permission to use logos should be requested from the Social Media Team.
9. Always protect yourself and the charity. Be careful with your privacy online and be cautious when sharing personal information. What you publish is widely accessible and will be around for a long time, so do consider the content carefully.

10. Think about your reputation as well as the charity's. Express your opinions and deal with differences of opinion respectfully. Don't insult people or treat them badly. Passionate discussions and debates are fine, but you should always be respectful of others and their opinions. Be polite and the first to correct your own mistakes.
11. We encourage staff to share tweets and posts that we have issued. When online in a personal capacity, you might also see opportunities to comment on or support POI and the work we do. Where appropriate and using the guidelines within this policy, we encourage staff to do this as it provides a human voice and raises our profile. However, if the content is controversial or misrepresented, please highlight this to the Social Media Team who will respond as appropriate.

Signed

Name

Date